

Level 3 Access Requirements

LEVEL 3 ACCESS REQUIREMENTS

1. **Rope to Rope Transfer with Casualty (SPRAT)**
2. **Rescue Through Re-anchor (SPRAT)**
3. **Rescue Through Deviation (SPRAT)**
4. **Rescue Through Knots (IRATA)**
5. **Mid Transfer Rescue**
6. **Tensioned Rope Systems**
7. **Rescue from Aid Traverse Short Link (IRATA)**
8. **Team Rescue/Work Scenario**

So you're going for your Level 3. Congratulations, that means that you've stuck with Rope Access for at least a year and have enough hours to qualify. That's great, you evidently like it.

Up to this point you've been either a rookie or a middle-of-the-road technician. You are certainly about to change. You have to take charge of the Rope Access Team and lead by example, make sure everybody working with you is safe and ensure that nobody outside of your sphere of operations is affected by your work. You're ready, you've worked hard for this opportunity, let's get certified.

You're going to have a tough week ahead of you. Level 3's are expected to be able to act upon every contingency imaginable, to think through any rescue, and to be there to lead and direct the team. As such, we'll have to build on your Level 2 rescue skills and you'll have to work hard - harder than you've done to this point to become a certified technician.

Assessment Requirements

The following Checklist shows what maneuvers, above that required by Level 1, and Level 2 are required for a Level 3 Rope Access Technician to perform during an assessment. The remainder of this section pertains to the specific training that you'll receive to ensure that you can perform these tasks during assessment.

Skill	Req'd
Rescue Through a Re-anchor (SPRAT)	✔
Rescue Through a Deviation (SPRAT)	✔
Rescue Past Knots (IRATA)	✔
Mid Transfer Rescue	✔
Tensioned Rope Systems	✔
Rescue From Aid Traverse Short Link (IRATA)	✔
Team Rescue/Work Scenario	✔
Hauling and Lowering Through Knots (SPRAT)	✔

Rescue Through Obstacles

Obstacles can become complex when conducting a rescue, but they all follow essentially the same process. Whether you're rescuing a casualty through knots, deviations or re-anchors, your goal is to transfer from one system to another while the casualty is attached to you.

It is important to point out a few things which will help make things a bit easier and safer:

1. Make sure the short link connection between you and the casualty is under all ropes, particularly loops. You don't want your casualty on one side of the loop and you're on the other. It's not impossible to fix, it's just a pain in the you know what!
2. Always go shopping. Once you've lowered the casualty onto the short link, grab his descender and maybe a back-up device and a few carabiners. You can get them later, but it's easier to get the stuff you need before you really need it.
3. Always use the casualty's cow's tail to make the second connection to you. You'll need your cow's tails to manage your fall factor during transfers.
4. Do not tangle your cow's tails. Look at the path of your cow's tails and ropes. Check often to ensure you haven't tangled something up. I call this "finding hold points". Double check everything every time you put something on a rope or take something off.
5. Always manage your fall factor. Consult the manufacturer's guidance for the back-up you are using.

There are a few rescues that you'll need to do, depending upon if you're training under the SPRAT or IRATA scheme. I'll briefly describe each.

Pass a Long Re-anchor with a Casualty (SPRAT)

So, a re-anchor is just a series of rope to rope transfers. Your casualty will be one the far side of the re-anchor. You'll have to negotiate the re-anchor to get to the casualty, but you learned

how to do that as a Level 1. Just remember to pay attention to the Casualty's equipment. You want to approach the casualty using his safety line as your working line, and so forth.

Pick the casualty off so that he's on your descender carabiner. Do a bit of shopping. This is a great time to make sure your ropes are not under the short link.

You'll want to descend down if you're above the far anchors. Position your descender so that it is slightly lower than the far anchors. Otherwise, don't descend, just carry on.

Add the casualty's descender to your harness. Make sure you capture your ventral D-ring and the short link connection. It's also a good idea that you position the descender on the side of your D-ring in the direction of travel. You don't want to get all tangled up.

Place a safety back-up on the transfer ropes. Pull all of the slack out of the safety line, ensuring that you don't tighten the cow's tail.

Place the other transfer rope into your new descender and remove all of the slack.

You'll install another lifting system like you did in the rope to rope transfer rescue. Climb towards your far anchors. I can't stress this enough: you do not want to descend into the bottom of the loop. Bad things happen there.

Once you've positioned yourself near the far anchors, use your original descender to descend down until the load is on the new descender. Remove it once it is slack. Remove your original back-up as well.

You will be hanging on the loop with exit ropes next to you. Take a look at your ropes. Nothing should be tangled or under your short link.

Remove the original descender and position it on the other side of the tensioned descender, keeping in mind that it has to capture both the central attachment and the short link. Place the empty descender on to the exit ropes, keeping in mind that it should not be placed above the loop ropes. Always move the ropes out of your way. Add your extra safety back-up you took off to the exit ropes.

Complete another transfer and descend to the ground.

Rescue Past Knots (IRATA)

Your casualty will be above the knots. Ascend past the casualty and perform a descent or ascent rescue, depending upon which equipment the casualty is using. Remember to go shopping.

Descend on your working line until the knot below your descender (on the standing end of the working line) is about 24" from your descender. You'll have to compensate for stretch in the

safety line, so stop further away from the knot if there is a large distance between you and the anchorage.

Working with your safety line, move the existing knot so that it is above the height of your descender. I prefer to move the knot by taking up the slack from above the knot and feeding it into the bight of the knot. When done properly, it ensures the damage is isolated and I don't have to leave equipment on a rope later.

Add the casualty's descender to your harness. Make sure you capture your ventral D-ring and the short link connection.

Place a back-up on your working line above your descender. You'll be "making twins" again.

Feed the rope under the knot in your safety line into the descender you just added to your harness. Get as much slack out of the rope as possible.

Transfer the load from the old descender to the new descender by operating the old descender. Remember to use additional friction.

Now that you've transferred from one rope over the knot to the safety line below the knot, take off the slack descender. Remove the original back-up and descend down. Keep in mind, you'll have a two-person load so it is very important for you to always manage your fall factor, keeping your back-up nice and high.

Negotiate the knot on your safety line by positioning your back-up devices appropriately.

Rescue Past Deviation (SPRAT)

So, the deviation is really just like the knots; you'll be transferring from your working line to your safety line. This technique works for single and double deviations.

Once the casualty is hanging on you and you've done a bit of shopping, descend until the top of your descender is a bit lower than the anchor connection of the deviation. You'll have to go a bit lower if the distance to the deviation is longer.

Using the ropes above the deviation, pull yourself into the deviation. You're doing two things here; judging your position to the deviation (you want the descender to be slightly lower than the lowest deviation anchorage), and you're grabbing the ropes below the deviation to lower yourself back out. Adjust your height if necessary (but don't go down too far).

You should be back under your top anchorages for the deviation, with the ropes from below the deviation in your hands, lap, etc. Go ahead and connect them to your harness for now.

Place a back-up above your descender on your working line. Look at that, you've made twins again.

Add the casualty's descender to your harness. Make sure you capture your ventral D-ring and the short link connection. It's also a good idea that you position the descender on the side closest to the deviation. You don't want to get all tangled up.

Grab your safety line (coming from underneath the deviation), and install it into your new descender. Pull all of the slack out of the rope. You'll move towards the deviation. Keep pulling. You want that descender as close as possible to the deviation, about 4" of clearance is good.

Just like you did in the knot rescue, you'll lower your first descender so that the load is transferred to your safety line. You are well protected because you installed a second back-up.

Take off the first descender once it is slack. Keep in mind you have two back-up devices that need attending (you don't want to get hung up on either).

Take off your first back-up and descend down a bit. You want to position yourself so that when you add the safety below the deviation your fall factor will be acceptable.

Add a safety back-up to your safety line below the deviation and remove the safety back-up that is above the deviation. There you go, you've rescued a casualty through a deviation. Good job!

Rescue from Aid Climb (Short Link IRATA)

The hardest part of rescue from aid seems to be the lifting and lowering part. You see, at best you'll be at the same level as the casualty, probably lower. This creates difficulties because you won't have the same leverage as if you were higher. Another difficulty is that you have to lower the casualty much further because you can't get higher.

Aid out to the casualty's location. Install a set of ropes at the casualty's location, one rope anchored to the anchor the casualty is suspended from, the other on your anchor.

Immediately put the rope located at the casualty into his descender. Remove all of the slack. Place a safety back-up from the casualty's harness on the rope next to you. The casualty will now be connected to the ropes you just hung.

Install a lifting system so that you can lift the casualty, creating slack in his cow's tail. I almost exclusively install a 5:1 mechanical advantage system using accessory cord.

Lift the casualty and release the short link carabiner connected to the anchor. It's going to be tough sledding because you have a very limited amount of room to lift. Make sure that the carabiner is either on the front or back, but never in the middle, trapped between two loaded carabiners.

You'll only have to lower the casualty a little bit because you placed the casualty on the ropes you installed. This slick little method will save you lots of heartache if your gear gets caught in pulleys or your accessory cord is short.

Now that the casualty is in descent mode on the ropes, all you have to do is get on the opposite ropes and perform a descent rescue.

You'll most likely need to perform a rope to rope transfer with the casualty to get to the final destination.

Mid Transfer Rescue

This rescue does not need to be hard. You'll have a casualty suspended between two anchors. Your job is to descend down the ropes to the casualty and take him to one side or the other.

The first thing you have to do is get to the casualty. If the casualty is in a re-anchor, no problem, climb the ropes leading to the loop. Get nice and high. If the casualty is in a rope to rope transfer, get to the casualty's anchors through aid climb or another technique as necessary. Hang a set of ropes and get on them.

Once you're on ropes leading to the ground, clip two carabiners to your sternal attachment (some people prefer their ventral) and attach these carabiners around the ropes supporting the casualty. Descend down the ropes you're on. You'll make your way to the casualty by riding along his tensioned line. This rescue is simplest if you have the foresight to bring an additional descender. Once you're able to grab the far side ropes, select the casualty's safety rope. Feed this rope into your extra descender installed correctly to your harness. Add a safety back-up from your harness to the casualty's far side working rope, above his equipment. Begin to climb using the new descender.

You'll develop slack in the two carabiners you installed on the transport lines Remove them. Establish the two connections to the casualty. It's best if that short link is pointed all the way down from your descenders (yes, make sure the short link captures both descenders) to the casualty's sternal connection. Lower the casualty's descender. You might have to climb a bit to release his chest ascender. Remove the casualty's safety gear.

You're all set to ascend in either descender, depending upon which direction you're going.

It's a bit more complicated if you don't bring an extra descender. I'll describe both methods here, but remember it's best to have an extra descender.

Mid Transfer: Ascent Side

You've got an extra step if you approach the casualty from the rope system his ascending gear is attached to.

The casualty's descender is supporting both of you from swinging back the way you came. It would be great if there were a way to keep that support while you take off his descender. Let's try this:

1. Install a back-up connected to a short link (take it off the cow's tail first) to the casualty's ventral D-ring so that the device is located on the casualty's working line above his descender.

2. Lower the casualty's descender until it is slack. Take it off of his harness and install it on yours.

3. Take the casualty's safety line (the one which was backing up the descender) and install it into the new descender on your harness.

4. Add one of your back-up devices to the casualty's working line above the hand ascender you just installed.

5. You are now connected to the rope system leading to the far anchors. Remove the casualty's back-up from that side.

6. Install a mechanical advantage system above your new descender and begin to climb the rope, creating slack between the hand ascender connected to the casualty and your back-up. Take off the hand ascender.

7. Remove your two carabiners from the travel lines.

8. Install a mechanical advantage system above your near-side descender and begin to climb the rope, creating slack between the casualty's chest ascender and your back-up. Take the rope out of the chest ascender.

9. Remove the casualty's back-up from the near side.

10. Place a rope grab above your descender in the direction of travel. Take the rope coming from your descender (the standing end) and install a pulley to it. Attach the pulley to the rope grab you just put on. You've just made a lifting system. It looks a lot like the 3:1 that you use in the lifting system, it's not. It's different only because the descender is moving in this example. (Don't call this a 3:1 whilst in Dwayne's presence, lest he gets miffed.)

11. Place an ascender with foot-loop on the rope you want to pull and go to work. It will be slow going, but not too bad. You can begin to descend using your original descender once you've cleared the obstructions or are sure you won't strike the ground.

Mid-Transfer: Descent Side

So, coming from the descent side is a bit easier . Since you'll be coming from the descent side, the descender will be next to you when you get to the casualty.

1. Make your two connections to the casualty. The short link may be a little difficult because the casualty's sternal attachment is further away from you. Don't descend down too far or you'll have a harder time making the attachment.

2. Once the two connections have been made, lower the casualty's descender. The casualty will be kinda hanging on you.

3. Remove the two carabiners you used on the travel lines.

4. Remove the casualty's back-up nearest you.

5. Remove the casualty's descender and install it on your harness, oriented so that it can be used on the far ropes.

6. Load the casualty's safety line into the descender. Pull out all of the slack.

7. Using your extra cow's tail, place a safety beck-up on the casualty's working line above his chest ascender. You now have two attachments to the far ropes.

8. Remove the casualty's hand ascender and safety back-up from the far ropes.

9. Install your handy lifting system to the new descender and climb towards the far anchor. This will eventually create some slack above the casualty's chest ascender; take it off.

10. You are now positioned to go either way, just make sure you install your handy lifting system on the descender in the direction of travel.

Access Permit (aka Job Hazard Analysis, JHA)

A written statement prepared by the employer describing how a particular job (or types of jobs where these will be essentially identical) should be undertaken to ensure any risks to health and safety of the workers, or others who may be affected, are minimized. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

SPRAT

Index Find Term

Access Zone

The area in which people are at risk of falling such as on-line or near a working edge. This area requires protective measures such as verbal warnings, signs, barriers, safety lines, or other devices designed to prevent or arrest a fall. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Anchor Device

personal fall protection equipment comprising an assembly of elements with one or more anchor points or mobile anchor points and which is removable from the structure or natural feature

---

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Anchor Lanyard

Lanyard connected to the main attachment point of the harness, which normally incorporates a connector and which is used for connection to an anchor point. ***IRATA***

Note: Some Anchor lanyards are also known as cow's tails.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Anchor Line

Flexible line connected to a reliable anchor to provide a means of support, restraint or other safeguard for a person wearing an appropriate harness in combination with other devices.
IRATA

Note: An anchor line may be a working line or a safety line.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Anchor Line Device

Collective term for ascending device, descending device and back-up device. ***IRATA***

Note: Anchor line devices are also known as rope adjustment devices.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Anchor Point

Point on an anchor device or structural anchor used for the connection of personal fall protection equipment. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Anchor Sling

Sling or strop made from textiles, wire rope or chain, which is used to attach to a structure or natural feature to provide an anchor point for an anchor line or for the direct connection of the rope access technician. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

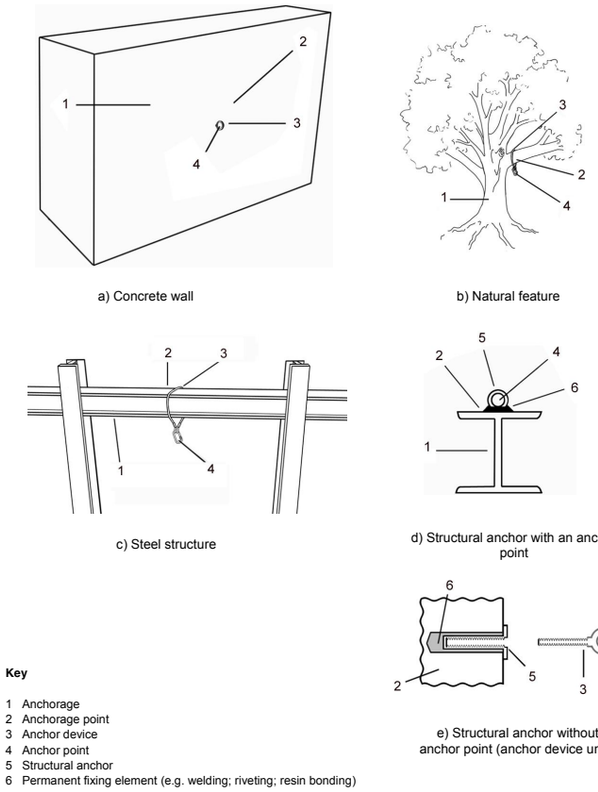
Anchor, Anchorage

A place, fixing or fixture that supports and to which the various ropes and rope systems are attached. ***SPRAT***

Anchor: general term used as a noun to describe a fitted or unfitted anchor device, or a structural anchor containing an anchor point, or as a verb to describe the act of connecting to a fitted anchor device or a structural anchor. ***IRATA***

Anchorage: Structure or natural feature that provides an anchorage point. ***IRATA***

Note: two examples of a natural feature (anchorage) are a rock face and a tree



Examples of Anchorages, anchorage points, anchor devices, anchor points and structural anchors (Figure 1.1 from IRATA ICOP Part 1)

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Anchorage Point

particular place on an anchorage used for the attachment of an anchor device. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Approved Equipment

Equipment deemed appropriate for use with rope access techniques. Approved equipment shall meet the specifications set forth herein (SPRAT Safe Practices for Rope Access Work), or other specifications set forth in the access permit, if more stringent. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Ascender, Ascending Device

A type of rope grab that is used primarily for climbing rope by griping the rope when loaded in one direction and sliding freely in the opposite direction. Note that many ascender type rope grabs are not sufficient for fall arrest. ***SPRAT***

Anchor line device used primarily to assist progression along an anchor line and for positioning the rope access technician on it, which, when attached to an anchor line of appropriate diameter, locks under load in one direction and slips freely in the opposite direction. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Attendant

An individual stationed at the site of the rope access work who monitors the rope access workers and who performs all Rope Access Attendant duties assigned in the employer's rope access work program. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Back-up Device

Anchor line device for a safety line, which accompanies the user during changes of position or allows adjustment of the length of the safety line and which locks automatically to the safety line, or only allows gradual movement along it, when a sudden load occurs. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Belay

An active system operated by another employee for the purpose of arresting the fall of a rope access worker. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Carabiner

A type of connector, formed as a complete loop with a spring-loaded entry gate. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Carabiner, Locking

A carabiner with a mechanism that reduces the possibility of a gate being opened inadvertently. A locking mechanism requires at least two different consecutive manual actions to open the gate. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Certificate of Conformity

Document certifying that the supplied goods meet the claimed compliance and/or specifications. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Competent Person

Designated person suitably trained or qualified by knowledge and practical experience to enable the required task or tasks to be carried out properly. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Competent Trainer

A person who, based on training, education, knowledge, and most importantly experience in rope access, can safely and effectively deliver a quantifiable educational program to others. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Connector

Openable device used to connect components, which enables the user to link himself or herself directly or indirectly to an anchor point. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Descender, Descending Device

A device that acts as a friction brake on a rope. It is normally attached to the operator and enables the operator to control the rate of descent. ***SPRAT***

Manually-operated, friction-inducing anchor line device which, when attached to an anchor line of appropriate type and diameter, allows the user to achieve a controlled descent and a stop with hands off anywhere on the anchor line. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Deviation

Redirection of the path of the anchor lines from the anchor points to avoid abrasion and other potential causes of damage to the anchor lines or to provide more accurate access for the rope access technician. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Deviation Anchor

Anchor placed primarily to alter the direction of an anchor line and installed at a distance (unspecified) from the anchor point(s) used for the first attachment of an anchor line. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Device Lanyard

Lanyard used to provide a link between the user’s harness and the anchor line device.

IRATA

NOTE Some device lanyards are also known as cow’s tails.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Dynamic Rope

A rope that is specifically designed to absorb the energy of a fall by extending in length thereby minimizing the shock load. ***SPRAT***

Rope specifically designed to absorb energy in a fall by extending in length, thereby minimizing the impact load. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Employer

A corporation, partnership, proprietorship, government agency, or other organization that authorizes its employees to perform rope access work. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Energy Absorber

Component or components in a fall arrest system designed to minimize the impact load generated in a fall. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Fail to Safe

Revert to a safe condition in the event of a breakdown, failure, or mismanagement of a critical nature. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Failure Load

Minimum breaking load of an item of equipment when it is new. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Fall Arrest

Equipment, system, or structure that catches a falling employee. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

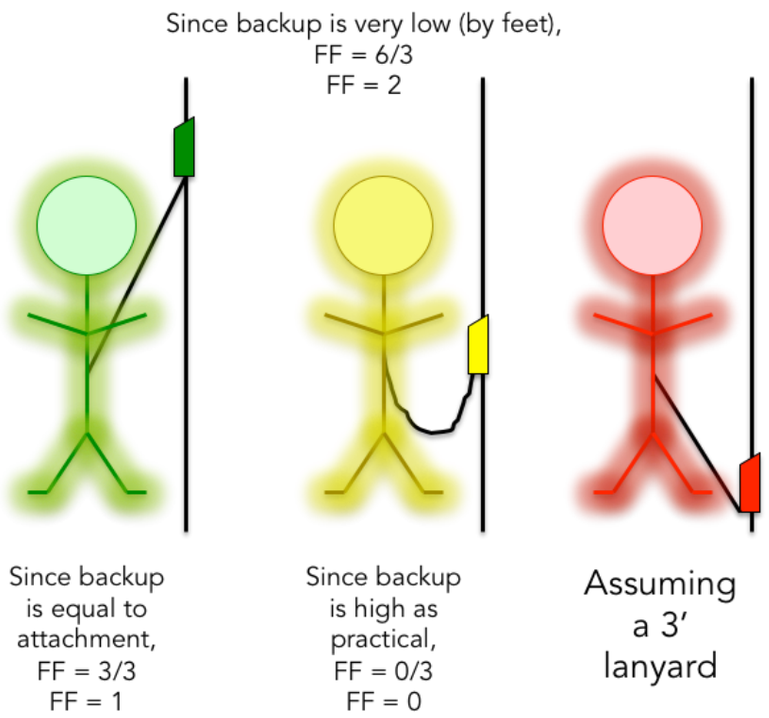
Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Fall Factor

The maximum distance a person could fall, divided by the length of the rope attaching the person to the anchorage point. ***SPRAT***

Length of a potential fall divided by the length of rope or lanyard available to arrest it.
IRATA



Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Fall Prevention

Equipment, system, or structure that prevents a fall from occurring. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Hazard Zone

Any area where a person may be at risk as a result of the work being performed. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Kernmantle Rope

A rope consisting of an internal load bearing core enclosed within a separate woven sheath. ***SPRAT***

Textile rope consisting of a core enclosed by a sheath.

Note: The core is usually the main load bearing element and typically consists of parallel elements which have been drawn and turned together in single or several layers, or of braided elements. The sheath is generally braided and protects the core, for example from external abrasion and ultra-violet degradation. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Level 1 Technician (Rope Access Worker)

An individual who performs rope access work. A Level 1 technician may only work under the direct, on-site supervision of a Rope Access Lead Technician or Supervisor. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Level 2 Technician (Rope Access Lead Technician)

An individual who is responsible for physically conducting rope access operations and/or safety evaluations of rope access operations, including maintenance of associated access equipment and performs all Rope Access Lead Technician duties as assigned in the employer’s rope access work program. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Level 3 Technician (Rope Access Supervisor)

An individual who is responsible for the overall rope access work site and performs all Rope Access Supervisor duties as assigned in the employer’s rope access work program.

SPRAT

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Lifting Equipment

Work equipment for lifting or lowering loads, including its attachments used for anchoring, fixing or supporting it, e.g. chain or rope sling or similar; ring; link; hook; plate-clamp; shackle; swivel; eyebolt; webbing. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Load-Sharing

Rigging the rope access system so that both redundant systems share the load or the load is equalized between components of the system. The picture below shows one system in a Y-Hang load sharing configuration.



Illustration created using vRigger

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Low-Stretch Rope

Textile rope with lower elongation and, therefore, less energy absorbing characteristics than dynamic rope. ***IRATA***

NOTE Low stretch rope is sometimes known as semi-static rope.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Main Line

The primary rope used for descending, ascending or positioning. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Maximum Rated Load (RL_{MAX})

Maximum mass of one or more persons, including tools and equipment carried, with which a component of a rope access system can be used, as specified by the manufacturer.
IRATA

Note 1: Maximum rated load is expressed in kilograms.
Note 2: See also safe working load (SWL) and working load limit (WLL).

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Minimum Rated Load (RL_{MIN})

Minimum mass of one or more persons, including tools and equipment carried, with which a component of a rope access system can be used, as specified by the manufacturer.
IRATA

Note: Minimum rated load is expressed in kilograms.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

On Line

The condition of being suspended from or attached to a rope. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

OSHA

OSHA is the Occupational Safety and Health Administration. These guys (and gals) regulate worker safety in the United States. They are an arm of the government that determines what an employer, jobsite, and employees should look and act like when working.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Chapter 1 - Fall Protection

Proctor

Individual who oversees students for test taking purposes. Proctor must be approved by SPRAT and submit a signed affidavit. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Proof Load

Test load applied to verify that an item of equipment does not exhibit permanent deformation under that load, at that particular time. ***IRATA***

Note: The result can then be theoretically related to the performance of the test piece under its expected conditions in service.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Re-Anchor

Anchor installed at a distance (unspecified) from the anchor point(s) used for the first attachment of an anchor line, to which the anchor line is additionally attached, and which is not a deviation anchor or an anchor placed simply to maintain the position of an anchor line. ***IRATA***

Note: Re-anchors are also known as re-belays and intermediate anchors.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Rescue Service

Organization determined by the employer to be capable of safe and effective rescue of rope access workers. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Rescuer

An individual who is designated by the employer to perform rescue of rope access workers as a member of the rescue service. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Retrieval

procedure for rescuing rope access workers without placing a rescuer on line. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Retrieval System

The equipment (including a retrieval line, harness, lifting device, and anchor) used for rescue of rope access workers without placing a rescuer on line. The safety line may be used as the retrieval line in a retrieval system.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Rigging for Rescue

Establishing a rescue system which enables workmate retrieval to take place without the need for a rescuer to descend or ascend to the position of the injured person. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Rope Access

Techniques by which access is gained to buildings, other structures (on or offshore), geologic features (such as cliff faces), or manmade features (such as dams) by means of ropes. It applies to all cases where ropes are used:

a. the primary means of support
b. as means of primary protection or positioning, and
c.where people descend or ascend on a rope or traverse along horizontal rope. ***SPRAT***

Method of using ropes, in combination with other devices, by which a user descends or ascends a working line to get to or from the workplace, and for work positioning, while further protected by a safety line, such that both lines are connected to the user's harness and separately secured to a reliable anchorage in such a way that a fall is prevented or arrested. ***IRATA***

Note 1: Ropes used for descending, ascending, work positioning or as a safety line are known as anchor lines.

Note 2: In this context, the term 'ropes' includes appropriate textile ropes, wire ropes and webbing.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Rope Grab

A device used to grasp a rope for the purpose of supporting a load. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Safe Working Load (SWL)

Designated maximum working load of an item of equipment under particular, specified conditions. ***IRATA***

Note: See also working load limit (WLL) and maximum rated load (RL_{MAX})

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Safe Zone

Any area outside the Hazard Zone or Access Zone. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Safety Line Controller

Person paying out or taking in safety lines while protecting another person against a fall from a height. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Safety Method Statement

Document prepared by the employer describing how a particular job (or types of job where these will be essentially identical) should be undertaken to ensure that any risks to the health and safety of the workers, or others who may be affected, are minimized. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Safety, Secondary, Belay, or Backup Rope (Line)

Rope used to protect against falls if the user slips or the primary support, anchor or positioning mechanism fails. ***SPRAT***

Safety Line

Anchor line provided as a safeguard to protect against falls if the rope access technician slips or if the primary support (e.g. the working line), anchor or positioning mechanism fails. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Screwlink

Type of connector formed as an open loop, which is closed by a threaded sleeve. ***IRATA***

Note: Screwlinks are also known as maillon rapides and quicklinks.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

SPRAT

Society of Professional Rope Access Technicians. ***SPRAT***

Related Glossary Terms

Access Permit (aka Job Hazard Analysis, JHA)

Index Find Term

Structural Anchor

Element or elements of an anchor incorporated into a structure or natural feature and not intended to be removed

A structural anchor may contain an anchor point.
A structural anchor is not an anchor device.
An example of a structural anchor is where an element such as an eyebolt is welded or resin bonded. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Suspended Scaffold

Scaffold suspended by means of ropes or chains and capable of being raised or lowered by such means but does not include a boatswain’s chair or similar apparatus. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Work Positioning

Technique that enables a person to work supported in tension or suspension by personal fall protection equipment in such a way that a fall from a height is prevented or restricted.
IRATA

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Work Restraint

Technique whereby a person is prevented, by means of personal fall protection equipment, including an appropriate belt or harness, from reaching zones where the risk of a fall from a height exists. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Working Line

anchor line used primarily for access, egress, work positioning and work restraint. ***IRATA***

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Working Load Limit (WLL)

Maximum load that can be lifted by an item under conditions specified by the manufacturer.

IRATA

Note: See also safe working load (SWL) and maximum rated load (RL_{MAX}).

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term

Workmate Retrieval

Removal by one or more operatives of an incapacitated member of their rope access work team from a place of danger to a place of safety. ***IRATA***

Note: Workmate retrieval is also known as workmate rescue.

Related Glossary Terms

Drag related terms here

Index Find Term